🏢 AgentCompany

User Guide — Updated April 2026

Now with real internet search · CEO Chat · History · Analytics · Settings

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1 — What is AgentCompany?

AgentCompany is an AI-powered virtual startup simulator. Give it an industry and 13 specialised AI agents research the market (using **real internet searches**), design a product, stress-test the finances, and decide whether to build. Everything logs to Notion automatically.

Typical run: $0.01–$0.05 · 3–8 minutes · GATE threshold 6.0/10

Agent	Role	Chamber	Web Search
SENTRY	Competitive Intelligence	Sentinel	✅ Real-time news
ARIA	Market Research	Chamber 1	✅ Real user pain points
NOVA	Product Strategy	Chamber 1	—
QUANT	Financial Intelligence	Chamber 1	—
GATE	Chief Risk Officer	Chamber 1	—
LEDGER	CFO — finance + token costs	Chamber 1	—
ARCH	Systems Architect	Chamber 2	—
PIXEL	Frontend Engineer	Chamber 2	—
CORE	Backend Engineer	Chamber 2	—
VIGIL	QA & Security	Chamber 2	—
APEX	Growth & Acquisition	Chamber 3	—
HAVEN	Customer Success	Chamber 3	—
ORCA-1	Infrastructure	Chamber 3	—

2 — Quick Start

Step 1 — Start the Server (Visible Terminal) NEW

Double-click `start_windows.bat` inside `E:\AgentCompany\AgentCompany\`

This opens a visible CMD window with live server logs — you can see every request, error, and agent activity in real time. It automatically frees port 8000 if something is already using it.

> ⚠️ *Keep the CMD window open. Closing it stops the server.*

Step 2 — Open the Dashboard

In your browser: `http://localhost:8000`

Step 3 — Run the Company

Type your industry in the top-right and click ▶ **Run Company**. Or use the CEO Chat bar at the bottom of the feed to type any task.

3 — The Dashboard — 4 Tabs NEW

📊 Dashboard Tab

The main control room. Four panels:

- **Top Bar** — Logo · Status badge · Nav tabs · Industry input + Run button
- **Left Roster** — 13 agents with status dots: gray=idle · blue pulsing=running · green=done · red=error
- **Centre Feed** — Real-time event cards from every agent. Border colours: blue=started, green=done/GO, red=KILL/error, gold=CEO action item
- **Right CEO Panel** — KPIs · Chamber progress · Gate decisions · Action items

CEO Chat Bar (bottom of centre panel) NEW

Type any message and press Enter or click Send:

What you type	What happens
`@ARIA find best niche in fintech for seniors`	Runs ARIA with your directive injected into her brief
`@QUANT re-model at $30/user, 70% margin target`	QUANT re-runs with your instruction as context
`Run an analysis on electric vehicle fleet software`	Full pipeline run for that industry
`Analyse the mental health app market`	Full pipeline run
Any free text	Treated as an industry/task description, starts full run

📋 History Tab NEW

Every completed run is automatically saved. Click any card to expand and see: gate composite score, product name, TAM, gross margin %, token usage, API cost, and CEO action items from that run.

📈 Analytics Tab NEW

Metric	What It Shows
Total Runs	All-time count of company runs
Pass Rate	% of runs where GATE issued GO
Total Spent	All DeepSeek API costs combined
Avg Cost/Run	Average API cost per run
Industries Tried	Bar chart of most-run industries
Pass/Kill Donut	Visual breakdown of GO vs KILL outcomes

⚙️ Settings Tab NEW

Change everything without editing code files. Changes apply on the next run.

Setting	Description
Default Industry	Pre-fills the industry input on the dashboard
GATE Threshold	Minimum score (1.0–10.0) to proceed to Chamber 2
Default Ad Budget	Default $500 — used when starting runs from the UI
Daily Budget Ceiling	Yellow alert at 80%, Red alert at 100%
CEO Name	Used in all reports and Notion pages
Notion Logging	Toggle auto-posting reports to Notion on/off
Agent Models	Switch each agent between deepseek-chat and deepseek-reasoner individually

> 💡 *Switch expensive agents (GATE, QUANT) to deepseek-chat in Settings to cut run costs significantly.*

4 — Real Internet Search NEW

SENTRY and ARIA now perform real DuckDuckGo web searches before calling the AI, so their analysis is grounded in current information — not just training data.

SENTRY searches for:

- `{industry} startup funding 2025 2026`
- `{industry} competitor news latest`
- `{industry} market trends 2026`
- `{product_name} competitors alternatives`

ARIA searches for:

- `{industry} user complaints problems 2025 2026`
- `{industry} app reviews negative feedback`
- `{industry} reddit problems frustrations`
- `biggest pain points {industry} customers`

Results are injected into the agent's prompt. The LLM then analyses actual news and real user complaints. No extra API key required — uses DuckDuckGo.

> 📌 *If DuckDuckGo rate-limits a search, the agent automatically falls back to LLM knowledge. The run never fails due to search errors.*

5 — GATE Scoring

Dimension	Weight	What It Measures
Market Opportunity	25%	TAM size, growth, timing
Competitive Edge	20%	How differentiated is the product?
Financial Viability	25%	Margins, unit economics, runway
Execution Risk	20%	Build complexity vs. team capability

Product-Market Fit	10%	ARIA friction + NOVA solution quality

Threshold: composite ≥ 6.0 = PASS · composite < 6.0 = KILL

> 💡 *"AI HR for SMBs" scores better than "HR software" — narrower niches win on Competitive Edge.*

6 — All API Endpoints

Endpoint	Method	What It Does
`/`	GET	CEO Dashboard HTML
`/run`	POST	Start a run: `{"industry":"...","ad_budget_usd":500}`
`/chat`	POST	CEO message: `{"message":"@ARIA analyse fintech"}`
`/status`	GET	Current run status + result JSON
`/events`	GET	SSE stream (used by dashboard automatically)
`/history`	GET	All past runs, newest first
`/analytics`	GET	Pass rate, total cost, industry counts
`/settings`	GET / POST	Read or update settings

7 — Troubleshooting

Server won't start

Double-click `start_windows.bat` — it automatically kills anything on port 8000 before starting.

No events after clicking Run

- Check the CMD window for Python errors
- Refresh the browser and try again
- Confirm `DEEPSEEK_API_KEY` in `.env` has credits

GATE always kills

- Try a narrower niche — broad markets score low on Competitive Edge
- Lower `GATE Threshold` slightly in Settings (e.g. 5.5) for experimental runs

Notion pages missing

- Check `NOTION_API_KEY` and `NOTION_PAGE_ID` in `.env`
- Or toggle Notion off in Settings if you don't need it

8 — Clean-Start Checklist

- Close the CMD server window
- In Notion: empty the 📁 Reports folder
- Double-click `start_windows.bat` to restart cleanly
- To fully reset history: delete
  `E:\AgentCompany\AgentCompany\data\history.json`
- To reset settings: delete
  `E:\AgentCompany\AgentCompany\data\settings.json`